interests.

Post-war decolonization began in Asia and the Middle East and then spread to other parts of the world. The late 1940s saw a number of countries emerging. These included the Phillipines (1946), India and Pakistan (1947), North and South Korea (1948), Myanmar (1948), Ceylon (1948), Indonesia (1949). Indo-China (Vietnam, Laos and Cambodia) became independent from the French colonizers in the 1950s. Middle East experienced struggle for independence with the expulsion of the French from Syria in 1946. North Africa, in the 1950s, witnessed a wave of political independence like Libya (1951), Sudan (1956) and the French colonies of Morocco and Tunisia (1956). Egypt remained a British protectorate until the overthrow of monarchy in 1952 and proclamation of a Republic in 1953. Iraq could also free itself from the British masters only with the ouster of King Faisal II in a nationalist revolution of 1958. In sub-Saharan Africa, Ghana got its independence in 1957 and Guinea in 1958. By late 1960s, almost all the colonies of Africa were successful in establishing their political independence.[1]

Causes for Decolonization

1. *Bankruptcy of the Imperial Powers*: The First World War had already exhausted the imperial powers and the Second World War, fought in quick succession, left them bankrupt. Huge losses incurred in terms of military, human and material resources exhausted them economically and politically. Further, the growing resistance to their domination in the colonies also made them fatigued and it became almost impossible for them to retain the colonies in Asia, Africa and Latin America. They had to concentrate on their socio-economic reconstruction back home, which implied that they had to withdraw from the colonies.

2. *United States and Decolonization:* USA, as already pointed out, in principle, supported decolonization efforts in order to contain the spread of Communism in these colonies. It championed the principles of self-determination and efforts to establish democratic governments that gave further impetus to the struggle against colonial powers.